RRB NTPC GK / General Awareness

High-Yield Medieval History Practice Questions (State PSC Solved Archive)

■■ Part 1: Maratha Empire & Later Kingdoms

Question 1

Exam Source: UPPSC PCS Pre (2020) & MPSC State Services Pre (2022)

In Chhatrapati Shivaji's Ashta Pradhan (Council of Ministers), which official was designated as the 'Sumant' or 'Dabir'?

A) Finance and Revenue Minister

B) Military Commander-in-Chief

C) Foreign Minister and Master of Ceremonies

D) Ecclesiastical Head and Charities Minister

Correct Answer: C) Foreign Minister and Master of Ceremonies

Detailed Explanation: Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj created a highly structured central administration called the **Ashta Pradhan** (a council of eight ministers). Every minister except the *Nyayadhish* (Chief Justice) and *Panditrao* (High Priest) was expected to lead military commands when needed. The **Sumant** (also termed *Dabir*) managed foreign diplomacy, received foreign ambassadors, sent envoys to other states, and briefed the king on cross-border political dynamics.

Designation	Core Responsibility	Modern Equivalent
Peshwa (Mukhya Pradhan)	General administration & state welfare	Prime Minister
Amatya (Mazumdar)	Managing state accounts, income & expenditure	Finance Minister
Waqia-Navis (Mantri)	Intelligence, records, household affairs	Home Minister
Surunavis (Sachiv)	Verifying royal correspondence & official edits	Head of Secretariat
Sumant (Dabir)	Foreign alliances, external intelligence & protocol	Foreign Minister
Senapati (Sar-i-Naubat)	Military recruitment, training, organization	Defense Chief

Question 2

Exam Source: BPSC CCE Pre (2018) & MPPSC Pre (2021)

What was the exact proportion of land revenue collected as 'Chauth' by the Marathas from the neighboring Mughal or non-Swarajya territories?

A) One-tenth (10%) of the total agricultural produce

B) One-fourth (25%) of the standard land revenue

C) One-third (33.3%) as a transit duty

D) Half (50%) of the crown lands

Correct Answer: B) One-fourth (25%) of the standard land revenue

Detailed Explanation: The Maratha tax structure was divided into internal revenue (within the sovereign zone called *Swarajya*) and external collections from frontier regions.

• **Chauth (25%):** Nominally one-fourth of the land revenue. It acted as a protection fee. By paying Chauth, a non-Maratha state or Mughal province secured a guarantee that the Maratha army would not raid their lands and would defend them from external threats.

• **Sardeshmukhi (10%):** An additional 10% levy collected on top of the regular revenue. Shivaji Maharaj claimed this as the hereditary *Sardeshmukh* (Supreme Head Desai) of the Maratha nation.

Question 3

Exam Source: UPPSC RO/ARO Pre (2021) & WBPSC Miscellaneous Pre (2019)

Which treaty brought an end to the First Anglo-Maratha War in 1782, restoring the status quo and securing twenty years of peace between the Maratha Empire and the British East India Company?

A) Treaty of Purandar (1776)

B) Treaty of Bassein (1802)

C) Treaty of Salbai (1782)

D) Treaty of Wadgaon (1779)

Correct Answer: C) Treaty of Salbai (1782)

Detailed Explanation: The First Anglo-Maratha War (1775–1782) began due to British interference in the internal succession disputes of the Peshwas. After years of fighting—highlighted by a Maratha victory at the Battle of Wadgaon—the British recognized that a decisive military breakthrough was unlikely. **Mahadji Shinde**, the brilliant Maratha statesman and general, mediated the **Treaty of Salbai** in 1782. Under this treaty, the British recognized Madhav Rao Narayan as the rightful Peshwa and returned captured territories, establishing peace between both empires for two decades.

Question 4

Exam Source: Karnataka PSC Pre (2020) & BPSC Pre (2022)

In which Anglo-Mysore War did Tipu Sultan finally lose his life defending his capital fortress at Seringapatam?

A) First Anglo-Mysore War (1767–1769)

B) Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780–1784)

C) Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790–1792)

D) Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799)

Correct Answer: D) Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799)

Detailed Explanation: The Kingdom of Mysore posed a significant challenge to British expansion in Southern India due to its modernized military administration and alliances with the French. In the Third War (1792), Tipu Sultan was defeated by Lord Cornwallis and lost half his kingdom under the Treaty of Seringapatam. Driven by the aggressive Subsidiary Alliance policy of Governor-General **Lord Wellesley**, the British launched a final attack in 1799. Tipu Sultan refused to surrender or accept subsidiary status, dying heroically on the battlefield defending the walls of his capital, Seringapatam, on May 4, 1799.

Question 5

Exam Source: WBPSC West Bengal Civil Services Pre (2023) & UPPSC PCS Pre (2017)

Which autonomous Nawab of Bengal shifted the provincial capital from Dacca (Dhaka) to a newly established city named after himself in 1704?

A) Murshid Quli Khan

B) Alivardi Khan

C) Siraj-ud-Daulah

D) Shuja-ud-Din Muhammad Khan

Correct Answer: A) Murshid Quli Khan

Detailed Explanation: As central Mughal authority fractured after the death of Aurangzeb, several powerful provincial governors carved out autonomous states. **Murshid Quli Khan** was originally sent as the *Diwan* (Revenue Administrator) of Bengal by Aurangzeb to streamline imperial tax collections. To secure the revenue administration from political instability surrounding the Prince at Dacca, he transferred the entire official machinery to **Makhsudabad** on the banks of the Bhagirathi River in 1704 and renamed it **Murshidabad**. In 1717, he was officially designated the *Nazim* (Governor), making Bengal a de facto independent state.

■■ Part 2: Bhakti & Sufi Movements

Question 6

Exam Source: MPSC State Services Pre (2021)

Which Varkari saint of Maharashtra composed the 'Eknathi Bhagavata', a celebrated vernacular commentary and adaptation of the 11th Skandha of the Bhagavata Purana?

A) Sant Dnyaneshwar

B) Sant Tukaram

C) Sant Namdev

D) Sant Eknath

Correct Answer: D) Sant Eknath

Detailed Explanation: The Bhakti tradition in Maharashtra was dominated by the **Varkari Sect**, who focused their devotion on Lord Vitthala (a form of Krishna) at Pandharpur. The movement sought to democratize spirituality by choosing local, vernacular speech over high Sanskrit. **Sant Eknath (16th century)** was a pioneer who insisted that Marathi was just as capable of expressing complex spiritual truths as Sanskrit. He wrote the *Eknathi Bhagavata*, completed the epic *Bhavartha Ramayana*, and meticulously edited the text of Sant Dnyaneshwar's classic work to preserve its authenticity.

Question 7

Exam Source: MPPSC State Services Pre (2019) & CGPSC Pre (2022)

The primary canonical compilation of the teachings and poems of Sant Kabir is known by which of the following names?

A) Padmavat

B) Bijak

C) Gita Govinda

D) Prithviraj Raso

Correct Answer: B) Bijak

Detailed Explanation: Sant Kabir was a central figure in the *Nirguna* Bhakti tradition, which rejected idol worship, rigid caste structures, and formal rituals in both Islam and Hinduism. He expressed his teachings through sharp, brief poetic couplets called *Dohas* or *Sakhis*. Following his death, his followers gathered his scattered verses into an official anthology titled the **Bijak**. The text is divided into three distinct lyrical meters: *Ramaini*, *Sabad*, and *Sakhi*, written primarily in the *Sadhukkari* dialect.

Question 8

Exam Source: Punjab PCS Pre (2018) & UPPSC PCS Pre (2016)

The mystical poetry and verses of which Chishti Sufi saint were deeply revered and incorporated into the sacred Sikh scripture, the Guru Granth Sahib?

A) Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti

B) Baba Farid (Fariduddin Ganjshakr)

C) Nizamuddin Auliya

D) Nasiruddin Chirag-i-Dehli

Correct Answer: B) Baba Farid (Fariduddin Ganjshakr)

Detailed Explanation: The Sufi movement shared common ground with the Bhakti saints through their emphasis on inner divine love, spiritual devotion, and rejection of formal religious barriers. **Baba Farid** (1173–1266 AD) was a prominent early master of the **Chishti Silsila** based out of Pakpattan. He wrote devotional verses in the local Punjabi and Multani dialects. Centuries later, Guru Nanak Dev and subsequent Sikh Gurus collected these compositions due to their shared focus on monotheism and inner purity. As a result, **134 hymns** and verses composed by Baba Farid were included in the *Guru Granth Sahib*.

Question 9

Exam Source: RAS/RTS Rajasthan Pre (2021) & UPPSC PCS Pre (2019)

Which medieval Bhakti philosopher and theologian propounded the school of 'Shuddhadvaita' (Pure Non-dualism) and founded the devotional path known as Pushtimarga?

A) Ramanuja

B) Madhvacharya

C) Nimbarka

D) Vallabhacharya

Correct Answer: D) Vallabhacharya

Detailed Explanation: The Bhakti movement was anchored by distinct philosophical systems (*Darshanas*) developed by major Achrayas. **Vallabhacharya (1479–1531 AD)** established the school of **Shuddhadvaita** (Pure Non-dualism), which taught that the entire universe is a manifestation of the Supreme Brahman (Krishna) without the distorting layer of illusion (*Maya*). He introduced **Pushtimarga** (The Path of Divine Grace), teaching that liberation is attained through unconditional, loving devotion to Krishna.

Summary of Philosophical Traditions:

- Adi Shankaracharya: Advaita (Absolute Non-dualism)
- Ramanujacharya: Vishishtadvaita (Qualified Non-dualism)
- Madhvacharya: Dvaita (Dualism)
- Nimbarkacharya: Dvaitadvaita (Dualistic Non-dualism)
- Vallabhacharya: Shuddhadvaita (Pure Non-dualism)

Question 10

Exam Source: UKPSC Uttarakhand PCS Pre (2022) & BPSC Pre (2015)

Which polymath, musician, poet, and historian of the Delhi Sultanate famously titled himself 'Tuti-e-Hind' (The Parrot of India) and was a disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya?

A) Ziauddin Barani

B) Hasan Dehlvi

C) Amir Khusrau

D) Malik Muhammad Jayasi

Correct Answer: C) Amir Khusrau

Detailed Explanation: Amir Khusrau (1253–1325 AD) was a prominent cultural figure of medieval India. As a close disciple of the Chishti saint **Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya**, he infused Sufi mysticism into his art and served in the courts of seven successive Delhi Sultans, including Alauddin Khalji. Proud of his Indian heritage, he declared himself the **Tuti-e-Hind** (The Parrot of India). Khusrau played a key role in the synthesis of Persian and Indian cultures. He is credited with introducing the *Qawwali* style of devotional music, innovating the *Ghazal* format in the subcontinent, and blending Persian with early Hindavi poetry.